

background, lock screen settings, account picture, taskbar settings etc. It will also sync your language preferences, network password, applications passwords and even web password. Windows Store apps can add support for syncing some of their settings as well, and Internet Explorer can already support syncing browser history, favourites etc. Once synced, these settings and personalisations will automatically be applied on any other devices linked to the same account, so you can keep your Windows desktop and tablet in sync.

There are other niceties as well, such as SkyDrive integration in Windows, so if you use that service you can open files from SkyDrive and save files to it just as you would to a local drive. It isn't just SkyDrive either, although that comes by default, you can install apps that give you similar level of access to other services such as Google Docs, Dropbox, SugarSync, and Box; there are even applications that include all these services in one package.

Sharing is also built into the OS – although only for the new kind of apps. Applications can support posting their content, and other apps can register to receive these posts. So if you install a social networking application, it will show up in the list of applications that can be used for sharing. So then other applications can post content, say a game posting a high score, to the social network of your choice via any of your installed social networking apps.

Windows 8 also features a much deeper search integration.

Windows 8 offers Store applications to participate in system searches, so now Windows can search for that book you bought on Kindle, or that location on Bing Maps or that contact in your address book app. All of this is integrated in the system so you can access search for all apps in a similar way, or you can run a system-wide search and get a list of all searchable apps right there.



All these settings can be synced if you have a local account linked to your Microsoft account

Digging Deeper

It might not seem like it but there is a lot more to Windows 8 than you can tell from its shiny but disjointed exterior. There are many amazing features